

Juan S. Gómez Cruces, Ph.D.

Universität Potsdam/Hasso-Plattner Institut
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Academic Positions

2024–present	Universität Potsdam/Hasso-Plattner Institut Post-Doctoral Researcher in Digital Technologies, Democratic Governance and Policy
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Education

2024	Georgia State University Ph.D. Political Science Subfields: Comparative Politics and Research Methods
2017	University of Colorado, Denver M.A. Political Science
2007	Instituto Tecnológico y de Estudios Superiores de Monterrey B.A. International Relations

Research Interests

Substantive: Digital technology, populism, and polarization.

Methodological: Computational social science, causal inference, and survey experiments.

Publications

2025	McCoy, Jennifer, Juan S. Gómez-Cruces, Ozlem Tuncel, & Levente Littvay. “Reducing Partisan Animus in Populist Contexts: Limitations of Shared Common Humanity and Perspective-Taking Interventions.” Chapter 14 in <i>The Ideational Approach to Populism: Consequences and Mitigation</i> , edited by Angelos Chrysosgelos, Kirk A. Hawkins, Eliza Tanner Hawkins, Levente Littvay, & Nina Wiesehomeier. Routledge Series: Extremism & Democracy.
2024	Gómez-Cruces, Juan S. “Forecasting executive approval with social media data: opportunities, challenges and limitations.” <i>Journal of Computational Social Science</i> (2024). https://doi.org/10.1007/s42001-024-00299-y
2022	Carlin, Ryan E. & Juan S. Gómez-Cruces. “Trust in Latin American Governing Institutions.” In <i>Oxford Bibliographies in Political Science</i> . Ed. Sandy Maisel. New York: Oxford University Press.

Working Papers

“Assessing the Impact of Populists in Power on Digital Governance” (Revise-and-Resubmit at *Journal of Information Technology & Politics*)

“Automated Political Stance Identification in Political Texts: A Transparent, Reproducible, Scalable and Theory-Driven Approach” (Under review)

“Interactions with Populist Leaders in Latin America on Social Media: A text-classification analysis using Large Language Models”

“Populists in Power and Their Online Engagement: Evidence from Presidential Twitter in Latin America”

Conference Papers

“Automated Political Stance Identification in Political Texts.” Accepted at the *RC33 11th International Social Science Methodology Conference*, Naples, Italy, September 2025.

“The Effects of Populist Rule on Internet Freedom.” Accepted at the *2025 European Political Science Association Conference*, Madrid, Spain, June 2025.

“Interactions with Populist Leaders in Latin America on Social Media: A text-classification analysis using Large Language Models.” Presented at the *2024 Southern Political Science Association Annual Meeting*, New Orleans, LA.

“Populist Rhetoric Depiction of Elites: Shadowy yet Ubiquitous?” (with Adrien Halliez). Presented at the *2024 Southern Political Science Association Annual Meeting*, New Orleans, LA.

“Forecasting Executive Approval with Social Media Data: Opportunities, Challenges and Limitations.” Presented at the *2023 American Political Science Association Annual Meeting*, Los Angeles, CA.

“Populists in power and online engagement with their rhetoric on social media. Evidence from Latin America.” Presented at *Broadening Our Approach: A Workshop on Comparative Political Communication*, Duke University.

“Are Social Media Eroding Political Trust in Institutions in Latin America?” Presented at the *2019 American Political Science Association Annual Meeting*, Washington, D.C.

Policy Reports

2025	Gómez-Cruces, J., Ranger, J., Jan, U., Thomas-Colquhoun, E. and de la Paz, E. <i>Path to Power: 2024 – The 2024 Mexican General Election</i> . (2024.3) Hasso-Plattner-Institut für Digital Engineering GmbH, Universität Potsdam.
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De la Paz, E., Ranger, J., Gomez-Cruces, J., Jan, U., & Thomas-Colquhoun, E. *Path to Power 2024: Global Democracy in the Age of Disruption*. (2024) Hasso-Plattner-Institut für Digital Engineering GmbH, Universität Potsdam.

Software & Digital Tools

2026 | **Automated Political Stance Identifier (APSI)**
 Team Leader. Open-source, theory-driven NLP tool for zero-shot political stance detection. Built and containerized (Docker) the public web application; maintain the open-source repository with reproducible workflows and documentation.
 Tool: <https://apsi.sc.hpi.de> Code: <https://github.com/juangomezcruces/apsi>

Grants, Fellowships & Awards

2024-2026 | *Digital Technology, Governance and Policy Post-Doctoral Researcher*, Deutsche Gesellschaft für Internationale Zusammenarbeit (GIZ) Grant, “Path to Power Project”.

2022-2024 | *Executive Approval Project Advanced Research Assistant*, National Science Foundation grant, “Public Support in Challenging Times: Varieties of Crises, Elite Responses, and Executive Approval” SES #2116467.

2022 | *Atlanta Area Computational Social Science Data Showcase Award*, Emory University, Atlanta, GA.
Summer Research and Professional Development Fellowship, Georgia State University, Atlanta, GA.

2020–2021 | *Graduate Research Fellow for the Democracy Program*, The Carter Center, Atlanta, GA.
Foreign Doctoral Scholarship, Consejo Nacional de Ciencia y Tecnología, Mexico
Complement Scholarship, Secretaría de Educación Pública, Mexico.

Teaching Experience

2025-2026 | **Universität Potsdam/Hasso-Plattner Institut**
 Instructor. Large Language Models (LLMs) for Social Research

2021–2022 | **Georgia State University**
 Instructor. Global Issues

2017 | **Instituto Tecnológico y de Estudios Superiores de Monterrey**
 Lecturer. Civil Society and Participation

Methods Training and Workshops

2026	<i>Large Language Models for Social Science</i> , Spring School in Advanced Research Methods, Oxford University, Oxford, UK.
2024	<i>Introduction to Methods of Causal Inference</i> , GESIS, Leibniz-Institut für Sozialwissenschaften.
2022	<i>Summer Institute in Computational Social Science</i> , Georgia State University, Atlanta, GA. <i>Winter School on Variations in Populism</i> , Arab Center for Research and Policy Studies, Doha, Qatar.
2021	<i>Computational Social Science Workshop and Datathon</i> , Emory University, Georgia Institute of Technology, and University of Georgia.
2020	<i>Machine Learning with Big Data for Social Scientists</i> , European Consortium for Political Research, Methods School, Central European University.
2019	<i>Summer School on Political Behavior in Latin America</i> , European Consortium for Political Research, Segovia, Spain.

Reviewer Service

Political Communication, Comparative Political Studies, Journal of Information Technology & Politics, Latin American Research Review, Revista Latinoamericana de Opinión Pública, International Journal of Public Opinion Research

Relevant Professional Experience

2025–present	Democracy Reporting International Digital Democracy Expert Berlin, Germany
2017–2024	Institute for Development, Evaluation, Assistance & Solutions Institutional Relations Consultant Decatur, GA, USA

Languages

Spanish (native), English (fluent), German (A1).

Programming & Data Skills

Python (advanced), R (advanced), SQL (intermediate); machine learning and LLMs, NLP, web scraping (Selenium), API-based data collection; Git/GitHub, Docker, reproducible research workflows; L^AT_EX, Qualtrics.